Question:

A 2-month-old girl is admitted to the hospital because of a 1-day history of fever and difficulty breathing. She has also had nasal congestion for 2 days. She was born at 28 weeks' gestation and weighed 1105 g (2 lb 7 oz); she currently weighs 2118 g (4 lb 11 oz). Her neonatal course was complicated by respiratory distress syndrome. She required supplemental oxygen for 36 days following birth. She was diagnosed with bronchopulmonary dysplasia 3 weeks ago. The infant missed an appointment with the pediatrician 2 weeks ago. Her only medication is vitamin D drops. She appears lethargic. Her temperature is 38.6°C (101.4°F), pulse is 160/min, respirations are 55/min, and blood pressure is 80/45 mm Hg. Pulse oximetry on room air shows an oxygen saturation of 87%. Physical examination shows moderate subcostal retractions. Wheezing is heard on auscultation of the chest. Her hemoglobin concentration is 10.5 g/dL, leukocyte count is 13,000/mm3, and platelet count is 345,000/mm3. Mechanic ventilatory support is initiated. After 4 days in the pediatric intensive care unit, the patient dies. Administration of which of the following is most likely to have prevented this patient's outcome?Answer Choices:A. Postnatal glucocorticoidB. CeftriaxoneC. Respiratory syncytial virus immune globulinD. Palivizumab

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>The assistant is thinking about the fact that the patient has a history of bronchopulmonary dysplasia, which is a complication of respiratory distress syndrome. This condition can lead to a variety of symptoms, including difficulty breathing, wheezing, and coughing. The patient's physical examination shows moderate subcostal retractions, which suggests that she is having difficulty breathing. The assistant is also thinking about the fact that the patient has a fever, which could be caused by a variety of infections, such as pneumonia. The assistant is considering the fact that the patient's neonatal course was complicated by respiratory distress syndrome, and that she required supplemental oxygen for 36 days following birth. This suggests that she may be at risk for a variety of complications, including pneumonia.</think><answer>C. Respiratory syncytial virus immune globulin</answer>